



PrepPal AI

Customer & MVP Blueprint

PRODUCT STRATEGY REPORT

SOURCE	STAGE	DATE	VERDICT
Validation Report	Pre-MVP	Jun 23, 2026	STRONG GO

STRONG DEMAND SIGNAL
Overall Readiness:
76 / 100

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

76

Overall Score

Customer + PMF + MVP combined

82

Customer Clarity

ICP is well-defined & reachable

88

Problem Severity

Real, urgent, recurring pain

71

PMF Potential

Strong signal; needs live validation

What This Report Is

This Customer & MVP Blueprint is built directly from the PrepPal AI Startup Validation Report. It translates market research and problem validation into a concrete product strategy — defining exactly who to build for, what to build first, how to price it, and the 30 actions needed in the next month.

Startup Idea	AI voice mock interviews tailored to Indian companies (TCS/Infosys/Amazon) with real-time feedback, progress tracking, privacy-first architecture	CLEAR
Core Problem	75% of tier-2/3 students fail interviews due to poor communication; no India-native AI coach exists	CRITICAL
Primary Customer	20–23 yr B.Tech students at tier-2/3 colleges entering campus placement season	DEFINED
Market Size	TAM \$3.96B SAM \$720M SOM \$7.2M (Yr 1-2)	LARGE
Competitors	No direct India-native voice AI competitor. Yoodli/Pramp are US-centric; InterviewBit covers DSA only	GAP
Validation	Pre-idea; 5-6 informal signals. Formal validation sprint required before full MVP	EARLY
MVP Approach	Text-based mock interview first (Week 2). Voice AI in v2 post-retention validation	READY

02 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE & BUYER PERSONAS

Age / Stage	20–23 yrs Final/pre-final B.Tech/BE	24–30 yrs 1–4 yrs work experience
Location	Semi-urban India: Pune, Jaipur, Bhopal, Coimbatore, Lucknow	Tier-1 cities: Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, NCR
Goal	Land campus job at TCS / Infosys / Wipro / Cognizant	Switch to product co. (Amazon, Razorpay, Zomato, Big 4)
Behavior	YouTube videos, peer mocks, LeetCode — dreads HR rounds	Self-study, cancelled peer mocks, uses ChatGPT informally
Core Pain	Freezes under pressure; never done a real mock interview	No time to schedule mocks; wants company-specific prep
Willingness to Pay	Rs.199–499/month (price-sensitive)	Rs.499–999/month (ROI-focused)
Device	Android smartphone primary	Laptop + smartphone
Decision Trigger	Placement season panic; first rejection; peer success story	Applied to dream job; interview scheduled; self-awareness

Buyer Personas

Akash

B.Tech CS, 3rd yr | VIT Bhopal | 7.2 CGPA

"I know my stuff but in the actual interview I just go blank. I need someone to talk to, not just watch videos."

- Checks LinkedIn for placement updates daily
- Re-watches "Tell me about yourself" videos repeatedly
- Willing to pay Rs.299–499/mo if placement odds improve
- Discovers via college WhatsApp group

Priya

Software Engineer, 2 yrs exp | Infosys Chennai

"I need something that knows what Razorpay actually asks, not generic practice. And I need it at 11pm."

- Codes at work all day; studies on weekends
- 3 mock sessions with friends — all cancelled
- Willing to pay Rs.699–999/mo; ROI = higher package
- Discovers via LinkedIn or Twitter/X ad

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

1	No realistic, pressure-simulating interview practice available	Daily	CRITICAL
2	No knowledge of what specific companies (TCS/Infosys/Amazon) actually ask	Pre-interview	CRITICAL
3	Freezing / blanking out under real interview conditions	Every interview	CRITICAL
4	Poor communication / English fluency under stress	Frequent	HIGH

5	High anxiety and low confidence approaching placement season	Entire season	CRITICAL
6	No structured feedback — only biased peer opinions or silence	After every session	HIGH
7	Peer mock interviews cancel 70%+ of the time	Scheduling	HIGH
8	Privacy concern — afraid weak answers will be used against them	Latent	HIGH
9	Cannot track improvement across sessions — no progress visibility	Ongoing	MEDIUM
10	Generic AI tools (ChatGPT) don't simulate interview pressure or structure	Daily use	MEDIUM

03 CUSTOMER JOURNEY | TRIGGERS | OBJECTIONS

Customer Journey Map

AWARENESS	CONSIDERATION	PURCHASE	RETENTION
• Placement season announced • Peer: "I don't know how to prep" • YouTube: "TCS interview tips" • Sees rejection posts on LinkedIn	• Searches "AI mock interview India" • Finds PrepPal via community/ad • Compares with Yoodli / ChatGPT • Sees free trial — low friction signup	• Completes 3 free sessions • Gets voice + content feedback • Sees improvement dashboard • Hits paywall → chooses Rs.299/499 plan	• Practices 3–5x per week • Tracks score improvement over 4 wks • Gets placed → shares story on LinkedIn • Refers 2+ friends via WhatsApp

Key Buying Triggers		Key Objections & Responses	
Placement season panic	Drive announced 3–4 weeks out — urgency spikes	"I'll just use ChatGPT"	No TCS patterns, no voice, no tracking — show gap in 60s
First interview rejection	Post-rejection willingness to invest jumps dramatically	"Rs.499 is expensive"	Rs.17/day. One placement = Rs.5–12L package. ROI obvious.
Peer success story	"My friend used PrepPal and got placed at TCS"	"I'll practice with friends"	Peer mocks cancel 70% of the time. PrepPal = 11pm, no judgment
Company-specific dream job	PrepPal has that company's Q-bank = instant purchase	"What if data leaks?"	Auto-delete 30 days. No 3rd party sales. Privacy policy front+center.
Free trial hook	First 3 sessions free, no card — quality does the selling	"Is AI feedback accurate?"	3 free sessions prove it. Add placed-student testimonials.

04 MVP RECOMMENDATION & MoSCoW PRIORITIZATION

What to Build First

BUILD FIRST (v1 Scope)

- Text-based mock interview engine (WhatsApp or web form) powered by Claude/GPT-4 API with India-specific Q-bank (TCS, Infosys, Wipro, HR/Behavioral)
- Post-session scoring: Answer Relevance (1–10) + Communication Clarity (1–10) + STAR method adherence — displayed immediately after each response
- Company selector: Student picks company + role before session; AI adapts questions accordingly
- Session history dashboard: Simple table showing scores across 5+ sessions so students can see progress
- Privacy page: Explicit "auto-delete 30 days" promise shown before first session — critical trust builder
- Free tier: 3 sessions free, no credit card. Razorpay paywall after session 3 (Rs.199/mo minimum)

DO NOT BUILD YET

- Voice AI (v1): High latency risk on Indian 4G; Indian accent STT accuracy needs dedicated training — validate content value first
- Mobile app: Web-first MVP is faster to ship and easier to iterate; app adds 4–8 weeks unnecessarily
- Resume builder, job board, aptitude tests: Scope creep — solve the mock interview problem perfectly first
- Group discussion AI, video analysis: Complex, expensive features for v1; users haven't asked for them yet
- Hindi-medium interviews: Important long-term but English-first reduces ML complexity for v1

MVP Success Metrics (30-Day Targets)

User interviews (qualitative)	25+ students	Confirms problem severity & WTP before code
MVP sessions completed	100+ sessions	Proves active use beyond curiosity
Session completion rate	>70%	Indicates engagement quality
Day-7 return rate	>40%	Habit formation = product-market fit signal
NPS score	>50	Love metric; drives viral word-of-mouth
Free → Paid conversion	>5%	Any paid user at pre-MVP = strong demand signal
WOM referral rate	>20% of signups	Validates viral loop in college WhatsApp communities

MoSCoW Feature Prioritization

MUST HAVE	SHOULD HAVE	COULD HAVE	WON'T HAVE (v1)
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• Text mock interview engine • India company Q-bank (TCS / Infosys / Wipro) • Relevance + Clarity scoring • Post-session feedback report • Company + role selector • Privacy page + auto-delete promise • Free 3-session tier • Razorpay payment integration	• Session history dashboard • Progress score trend chart • STAR method coaching tips • Email/WhatsApp session reminder • 5 companies in Q-bank (not just 3) • Basic NPS prompt after session 3	• Voice AI (v2 candidate) • Hindi-medium option • Referral reward system • Personalized prep plan generator • Group Discussion AI practice • LinkedIn share card (score badge)	• Mobile app (ship web first) • Video body language analysis • Resume builder • Job board / matching • Real-time audio-to-text live coaching • Recruiter analytics dashboard
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05 PRICING HYPOTHESIS | TOP 5 RISKS | 30-DAY MVP PLAN

Pricing Hypothesis

Free	Rs.0	3 mock sessions (TCS/Infosys), basic score report	All first-timers	Remove friction, build trust, create habit
Student	Rs.199/mo	20 sessions/mo, 5 companies, score history, prep tips	Price-sensitive tier-2/3 student	Beachhead volume + viral spread
Pro	Rs.499/mo	Unlimited sessions, 15 companies, HR+Tech+Behavioral, progress analytics	Serious placement aspirant	Primary revenue tier
Professional	Rs.999/mo	Everything + voice AI (v2), custom company packs, resume coaching	Working professional / job switcher	High LTV; early adopter pool
B2B College	Rs.50K–2L/yr	Placement cell dashboard, bulk student access, admin analytics	Tier-2/3 placement cells	Recurring revenue; zero CAC per student
Pricing Rationale: Rs.17/day framing neutralizes "expensive" objection. Competitor Yoodli charges ~Rs.2,000/mo — PrepPal at Rs.499 is a 75% discount with India-first features. B2B college deals provide ARR stability to offset seasonal B2C swings.				

Top 5 Risks

Large player (Unacademy/upGrad) copies product	HIGH	Move fast. Build India Q-bank moat + privacy brand that takes years to copy
Solo founder execution bottleneck	HIGH	Find technical co-founder in 30 days via YC co-founder matching / AngelList
Low WTP — students expect free tools	MEDIUM	Generous free tier + clear ROI framing (Rs.17/day vs. Rs.12L package uplift)
Voice AI latency / Indian accent accuracy	MEDIUM	Ship text-only v1; introduce voice only after retention proven in v1
Seasonal revenue (placement season only)	LOW	Year-round working professional segment + B2B college licensing smooths curve

30-Day MVP Plan

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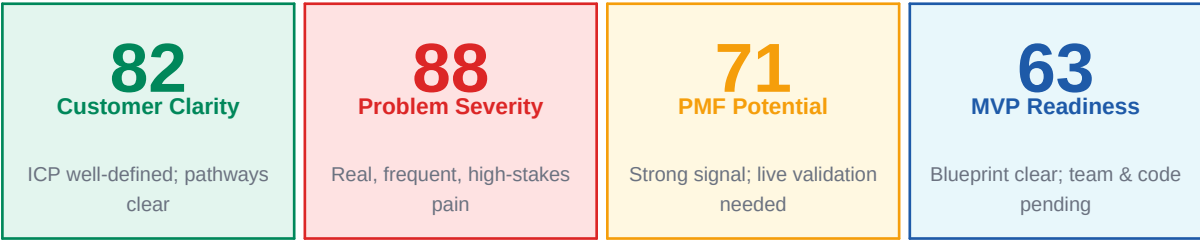
Week 1 Days 1–7	Customer Discovery	• Interview 15+ tier-2/3 students (WhatsApp/Typeform) • Wizard of Oz: manually interview 5 students, give feedback • Map top 3 company Q-banks (TCS/Infosys/Wipro)	25 interviews done; 3 pain points confirmed
Week 2 Days 8–14	MVP Build	• Text-based mock on web form using Claude/GPT-4 API • Implement scoring rubric (relevance + clarity + STAR) • Run with 30 students; track completion rate	100 sessions; >70% completion; Day-7 return >40%
Week 3 Days 15–21	Distribution & Monetization	• Post in 10 college WhatsApp groups + LinkedIn + Twitter • Add Razorpay paywall after session 3 (Rs.199/mo) • Interview 10 non-converters; fix messaging/pricing	5+ paying users; conversion rate measured
Week 4 Days 22–30	Accelerator Prep	• Compile traction data (NPS, conversion, quotes) • Draft YC / 100X.VC application • Research voice STT (Assembly AI / Deepgram for Indian accent) • Find 1 technical co-founder	YC app draft ready; co-founder shortlist of 3

06 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET | SCORES | FINAL VERDICT

Top 10 Next Actions (This Week)

TODAY	Write your problem statement in 1 sentence and share with 5 friends. Measure: Do they immediately say "YES I have this problem"?
DAY 2	Create a Typeform with 7 questions. DM 20 engineering students in your college network for a 10-min interview. Offer a free PrepPal session as incentive.
DAY 3	Map out 30 TCS NQT questions + 30 Infosys InfyTQ questions from publicly available sources. This is your first Q-bank.
DAY 4	Do 1 Wizard of Oz mock interview manually with a classmate. You play the AI. Document what questions you asked and what feedback you gave.
DAY 5	Set up a simple Google Form: "Select company (TCS/Infosys/Wipro) → Answer 3 interview questions → Get AI feedback." This is your Day-1 MVP prototype.
WEEK 1 END	Summarize interviews: What are the top 3 pain points? Which companies are most requested? What would users pay? Document all verbatim quotes.
WEEK 2	Integrate Claude/GPT-4 API to replace manual feedback. Add scoring (1-10) for Relevance and Clarity. Test with 30 students.
WEEK 2	Post in 3 college WhatsApp groups: "Free AI mock interview for [College Name] placement prep — TCS/Infosys patterns. No signup needed." Measure clicks.
WEEK 3	Add Razorpay payment after session 3. Price: Rs.199/month. Every paying user = validation. Track and name each one.
WEEK 4	Start co-founder search: Post on LinkedIn, YC co-founder matching, AngelList Talent. Look for a Full-Stack or ML engineer with India edtech interest.

Validation Scores



Problem Severity Deep-Scan



FINAL VERDICT

 STRONG DEMAND SIGNAL

PrepPal AI addresses a real, urgent, and currently unsolved problem for 8M+ Indian students. The market gap is structural, the founder-market fit is strong, and no India-native AI competitor exists. The 30-day validation sprint is the critical next step before full MVP investment. **Build the text MVP. Talk to 25 users. Ship. Learn. Then build voice.**